Chandranna Pelli Kanuka Scheme

1. Executive Summary & Scheme Vision

The Chandranna Pelli Kanuka scheme is a high-impact social welfare initiative administered by the Government of Andhra Pradesh across multiple welfare departments. The scheme provides structured financial assistance to poor, economically disadvantaged, and marginalized families celebrating the marriage of their daughters. By linking financial disbursal directly to legal age, mandatory minimum education, and formal marriage registration, the policy directly counters child marriage, promotes inter-caste harmony, protects women's socio-economic security, and prevents unorganized high-interest debt among vulnerable households. The core mandate enforces rigid age verifications and universal formal marriage registration with institutional oversight.

2. Financial Assistance Structure by Category

Financial incentive amounts vary based on the social category of the couple and special affirmative criteria. All incentives are remitted directly to the bride's Aadhaar-seeded bank account via Direct Benefit Transfer. For an SC/ST intra-community marriage, where both belong to the SC or ST community, the bride receives Rs. 1,00,000. In an SC/ST inter-caste marriage, the financial assistance is elevated to Rs. 1,20,000. For Backward Classes (BC) participating in an intra-community marriage, the grant is Rs. 50,000, while a BC inter-caste marriage provides Rs. 75,000. If the bride belongs to a registered Minority community under BPL, the assistance is Rs. 1,00,000. In cases where either the bride or groom is physically challenged (Differently Abled with minimum 40% SADAREM), the incentive is Rs. 1,50,000. Lastly, registered members or children of the AP Building & Other Construction Workers (BOCW) welfare board receive Rs. 40,000.

3. Detailed Eligibility Criteria & Saturation Norms

Strict demographic mandates dictate that the bride must have completed 18 years of age and the groom must have completed 21 years of age by the date of solemnization. Both must be permanent residents of Andhra Pradesh, and this must be their first marriage. Crucially, both the bride and groom must have passed their 10th Standard (SSC) board examination to enforce adolescent school retention. Economically, the total family income must not exceed Rs. 10,000 per month in rural areas and Rs. 12,000 per month in urban zones. Total aggregate landholding must remain strictly below 10 acres, and domestic power consumption must be under 300 units per month. Families owning four-wheelers (except commercial livelihood vehicles), holding large urban properties, or comprising regular government employees are strictly excluded.

4. Comprehensive Documentation Checklist

Applicants must upload digitally scanned original documents via MeeSeva or the GSWS portal. Valid Aadhaar Cards of both the bride and groom are required for identity and biometrics. Proof of age and education is satisfied by an SSC marks memo or transfer certificate explicitly indicating the date of birth for both individuals. An integrated Caste Certificate proves community status. The bride's family must provide an active White Rice Card or an Income Certificate to establish poverty status. Marriage verification requires wedding invitation cards, priest declarations, and wedding photos, which must subsequently be backed by a formal statutory Marriage Registration Certificate issued by a competent registrar. The bride must also supply an active bank passbook showing IFSC and account details linked to Aadhaar for the disbursal. If applicable, a SADAREM Certificate is required to verify disability.

5. Step-by-Step Application & Processing Workflow

The process mandates that families submit a preliminary online application at least 15 days prior to the wedding date. Following this, welfare assistants conduct a field visit within 7 to 10 working days to verify residence, age, education, and economic standing. After the marriage solemnization, the couple must complete statutory registration within 30 to 60 days. They then upload the official Marriage Certificate, joint photographs, and complete biometric authentication at the local secretariat. The final beneficiary list undergoes a social audit and multi-level sanctioning before the approved grant amount is disbursed directly via the Comprehensive Financial Management System into the bride's bank account.